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Week 17 Lit Example Worksheet

SHAKESPEARE: SELF-DECEPTION

Purpose: Apply Week 17's self-deception autopsy to Macbeth's private reasoning and Brutus's orchard justification.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not retell the plot; use multiple Whately tools on each speaker's self-justification.

Part 1: Macbeth — Desire and Knowledge

Question 1.1

What desire or feared loss drives Macbeth in the Passage 1 speech, and what conclusion is he testing?

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

What reasons against the murder does Macbeth already see, and what spur does he name?

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Macbeth — Autopsy

Question 2.1

Surface a hidden assumption that would be needed to treat the murder as acceptable, and name one Whately tool that exposes later self-deception risk.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Offer a repaired narrower claim Macbeth could honestly make at this moment without pretending necessity.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Brutus — Private Case

Question 3.1

What desire for Rome or for his own honor seems to drive Brutus, and what conclusion does he reach?

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

What stated reasons and analogy does he use, and what remains unproved?

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Full Map and Comparison

Question 4.1

Complete a self-deception autopsy for Brutus: desire, conclusion, stated reasons, hidden assumption, exposing tool, remaining need, repaired claim.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

Compare Macbeth and Brutus. How can private reasoning hide from itself while still using recognizable logical forms?

Part 4 Q2